

MUS 9.01: Introductory Guitar

Winter 2025

Location: Sudikoff 005

Time: 10A: T/Th 10:10 AM-12:00 PM, 10AX: F 3:30-4:20 PM

Enrollment limit: 16 students maximum, by instructor permission

Instructor: Jason Ennis

Lecturer in Jazz and Popular Styles Guitar

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(He/him/his)

Office hours: T/W/Th 12:00-1:00PM, by
appointment (Location TBD)

Teaching Assistant: Andrew Brozek

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Office hours: F 4:30-5:30PM,
Sudikoff 005 (TBC)

Course Schedule- Week 5 to End

Subject to change

Week 5

Tuesday, February 4: Review all material for midterm

- Introduction to staff notation:
 - *A Modern Method for Guitar, Vol. 1*, pp. 3
 - Richard Miller handout: "Notes on the First 3 Strings"
 - Richard Miller handout: "Notes on the Last 3 Strings"
- Fingerboard knowledge/improvisation: E blues
 - Review
 - Add 7th position fingering of blues scale and notate in fretboard diagram

Thursday, February 6: Midterm Exam/Performance

- **First hour: Private proficiency exam with instructor or TA**
 - Step pulse and clap rhythms:
 - Quarter notes, any downbeat of measure
 - Straight and swing eighth notes, any upbeat of measure
 - Half notes and **backbeat**
 - **Tresillo/lundu/second line**
 - **3 + 2 clave**
 - Chromatic warmup patterns: Sixteenth note variation, any LH permutation, 60 bpm
 - E blues scale, swing eighth notes, 2 octaves, 60-72 bpm

- C major scale, 1st position, 60 bpm:
 - Ascending and descending, repeating tonic, eighth notes
 - Thirds pattern/sequence, quarter notes
 - Tetrachord pattern/sequence, “backstepping,” quarter notes
- **Second hour: Performance for full class, duos or trios:**
 - Song of choice, accompanied by open position chords. Each group member sings
 - Arrangement of 12-bar blues form, with or without sung lyrics:
 - Has uniquely arranged introduction and ending
 - Demonstrates different comping approaches (full or power chords, etc.)
 - Has some riff-based element
 - Features soloing and trading choruses. Each group member solos at least 2 choruses

Friday, February 7: Optional X-hour drill session with TA

Week 6

Tuesday, February 11

- Rhythm: **3 + 2 *clave*** and ***tresillo*** with swing eighth notes
- Technique: Review and Drill
- Fingerboard knowledge/theory: C major scale
 - Review (fingerings, patterns, songs)
 - Triad arpeggios (see “Introduction to the Major Scale” worksheet):
 - Play mechanically by “stacking” 3rds
 - Identify/sing note names and scale degree numbers
 - Define diatonic triads and quality thirds and triads
 - **Assignment**: Notate and identify each triad on worksheet
- Staff notation:
 - *A Modern Method for Guitar, Vol. 1*, drill p. 4 in 2 bar phrases
 - **Assignment**: *A Modern Method for Guitar, Vol. 1*, p. 5

Thursday February 13

- Rhythm: Review **3 + 2 *clave*** and ***tresillo*** with swing eighth notes
- Fingerboard knowledge/theory/repertoire: C major scale
 - Review diatonic triads
 - Introduce “triad waltz”
 - Songs: “[Like a Rolling Stone](#)” (Bob Dylan) and “[I Will Survive](#)” (Freddie Perren and Dino Fekaris, performed by Gloria Gaynor)
- Technique: Fingerstyle introduction
 - Basic positioning and technique
 - Fingerstyle handout, first 3 lines
- Staff notation:
 - *A Modern Method for Guitar, Vol. 1*, review exercises. 1-4

- **Assignment:** *A Modern Method for Guitar, Vol. 1*, “Sea to Sea,” (pp. 6-7)
- Technique/FBK: Introduction to bar (barre) chords
 - Definition, forms, overcoming technical challenges (see handout)
- Repertoire/FBK: “Iko Iko”
 - Strumming pattern and variations
 - Chord progression
 - Suggested **listening and reading**:
 - The Dixie Cups, [“Iko Iko”](#)
 - The Neville Brothers, [“Brother John / Iko Iko / Jambalaya / They All Ask’d for You”](#)
 - Dr. John, [“Iko Iko”](#)
 - [Wikipedia entry on “Iko Iko”](#)
 - Bo Diddley [“Bo Diddley”](#)

Friday, February 14: Optional X-hour drill session with TA

Week 7

Tuesday, February 18

- Staff notation:
 - *A Modern Method for Guitar, Vol. 1*: **Quartets perform “Sea to Sea,” p. 6-7**
 - **Assignment:** Exercises 5-8 (pp. 8-9)
- Technique: Fingerstyle
 - Review basic positioning and technique
 - Fingerstyle handout, 1st page
- Repertoire/FBK: “Iko Iko”
 - Introduce moveable blues scale and pentatonic forms: notate on fretboard diagram
 - Jam on tune, using moveable forms of blues scale and pentatonic
 - Add Dr. John “interlude riff”

Thursday, February 20

- Fingerstyle technique:
 - Introduce method of isolating LH and RH to practice
 - Work through “Practicing Right Hand Finger-style Technique” handout through top of 2nd page.
 - **Assignment:** apply to A section of “Blackbird” (McCartney/Lennon)
- Staff notation:
 - *A Modern Method for Guitar, Vol. 1*: Review Exercises 5-8 (pp. 8-9)
 - **Assignment:** Duet on pp. 10-11, “One, Two, Three, Four.”
- Fingboard knowledge/theory/technique:
 - Introduce G major scale, 1st pos. (derived from C major/G Mixolydian form)
 - Play with “backstepping”
- Repertoire/technique:
 - Begin “Blackberry Blossom” by rote

- **Assignment:** Learn as much of basic version of “Blackberry Blossom” as possible
- Optional **listening:**
 - Tony Rice, [“Church Street Blues”](#)
 - The Punch Brothers, [“Church Street Blues”](#)
 - Molly Tuttle [“White Freightliner Blues”](#)

Friday, February 21: Mandatory X-hour drill session with TA

- Continue “Blackberry Blossom” by rote

Week 8

Tuesday, February 25

- Rhythm: Review all and add 3/4, quarter and eighth notes
- Staff notation:
 - *A Modern Method for Guitar, Vol. 1: Quartets perform “One, Two Three, Four” (pp. 10-11)*
 - **Assignment (For 2/9):** Exercises 9-10 (pp. 12-13), “Imitation Duet” (p. 14), “Sharps and Flats” (p.15)
- Finger-style technique/repertoire:
 - Review A section of “Blackbird”
 - **Assignment:** Learn all of [“Blackbird”](#) on own
- Repertoire:
 - Learn remainder of “Blackberry Blossom” by rote
 - Introduce “boom-chuck” chordal accompaniment pattern

Thursday, February 27

- Rhythm:
 - Dotted quarter notes in 3/4 (2 against 3 polyrhythm)
 - 6/8 meter
- Fingerboard knowledge/theory:
 - Introduce position playing of C major scale (“Major Scale Fingerings” handout)
 - Pentatonic variation
 - **Assignment:** C major scale, position II, with patterns/sequences
 - **Assignment:** “Twinkle, Twinkle” and/or “Frere Jacques” in 2 octaves of C major, pos. II
- Repertoire:
 - Review and play “Blackberry Blossom”
 - Introduce concept of **tempo matrix**
 - **Assignment:** Make “Blackberry Blossom” with **tempo matrix** a central part of warmup

Friday, February 28: Optional X-hour drill session with TA

Week 9

Monday, March 3 8:00PM

Mandatory Concert: [Coast Jazz Underground](#), Featuring Dartmouth Jazz Faculty and Student Combos. Sawtooth Kitchens, Hanover, NH

Tuesday, March 4

- Fingerboard knowledge/theory:
 - Review position playing and C Major, position II
 - Add position V
- Staff notation:
 - *A Modern Method for Guitar, Vol. 1: Quartets perform “Imitation Duet” (p. 14)*
 - Introduce key signatures (pp. 30, 35, 43, 47, 50, 53, 56)
 - Discuss/encourage students’ moving forward on own with book
- Repertoire:
 - Review and play “Blackberry Blossom”
 - Review A section of “Blackbird”
 - **Assignment:** Notate LH fingerings for Prelude, Op. 114, No. 4 (Fernando Carulli) on fretboard diagrams
- Suggested **listening:** Classical guitar
 - Julian Bream, [Capricho Arabe](#) (Francisco Tárrega)
 - David Russell, [Suite for Lute, BWV 996](#) (J. S. Bach)
 - Ana Vidovic, [Asturias](#) (Isaac Albéniz)
 - Sergio and Odair Assad, [Baião Malandro](#) (E. Gismonti, arr. S. Assad)

Thursday, March 6

- Rhythm: West African clapping game
- Repertoire:
 - Check fretboard diagrams of Carulli harmony
 - **Assignment:** Prelude, Op. 114, No. 4 (Fernando Carulli)
 - Jam on Blues in G: Emphasize the tonic and develop ideas
- Recital Prep
- Review all material for final performance test

Thursday, March 6, 7:00PM:

Culminating public performance, Studio Sudikoff (TBC)

- Each student performs:
- Two tunes with trio/quartet:
 - **Song 1 (Ensemble's choice):**
 - Intro of some sort
 - Everyone sings on main form. Maximum 2 verses, 2 choruses, 2 pre-choruses or bridges (that part that leads into the chorus) Minimum 2 verses, 1 chorus.
 - Outro/ending
 - Demonstrate at least 2 different types of accompaniment (for example, single note riff and strummed chords)
 - **Song 2 (Blues in G or "Iko Iko):**
 - Intro
 - Maximum 2 verses sung (optional)
 - Solos: each member plays 2 choruses of improvisation (twice through the 12-bar form)
 - Maximum 1 verse sung (optional)
 - Outro/ending
 - Demonstrate at least 2 different types of accompaniment (for example, single note riff and strummed chords)
- **One tune with entire group** (TBD, possibly "Blackberry Blossom")

Friday, March 7: Optional X-hour drill session with TA

- Blackberry Blossom review and practice session
- Extra help with Carulli, etc...

Thursday/Friday, March 13/14 10:00AM-2:30PM: Final Exams via Zoom

- **It is student's responsibility to test zoom connection before meeting!**
- **Private proficiency exam with instructor (20-30 minutes):**
 - Dance and clap "West African Clapping Game"
 - C Major scale: "Triad Waltz" pattern and "Twinkle, Twinkle" positions I, II, V and VII, 60 BPM (each position graded separately)
 - E blues scale, positions I and VII, swing eighth notes, 82 BPM
 - G major pentatonic scale, positions I and VII, eighth notes, 82 BPM
 - G blues scale, positions III and X, swing eighth notes, 82 BPM
 - "Blackberry Blossom," AABB form 2x (Melody 1x, Chords 1x), 82 BPM
 - Top part for "Imitation Duet," 72 BPM
 - One solo piece: *Romance Etude* (Ferrara), or *Prelude* (Carulli)
 - Optional: Second attempt at any material from midterm